Fan/Friction: Concerts Ticketmaster Misses (5,000+)

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Summary

Add the SeatGeek API as a catch-all feed and crawl AXS venue/artist pages; together they surfaced most of the sample I checked, and AXS also lists Goldenvoice co-promoted DICE shows like the PAWSA example. Trial JamBase as a normalized multi-seller feed before committing.

- **Biggest misses are not on any one alternative seller.** Insomniac megafestivals sell on Front Gate, arena shows on AXS, pop-ups on DICE, and LA Phil Hollywood Bowl shows on the Bowl's own box office.
- **Your example is catchable.** PAWSA (Oct 17) has an AXS listing whose buy button hands off to DICE, and Framework's site shows a waitlist, which signals a sell-out.
- **Pop-up capacity is the hard part.** Permits and city contracts are the most reliable source; promoter press releases are the usual one in practice; aggregator capacity fields are often wrong.
- **Outside LA:** AXS holds up in Las Vegas (MGM/AEG arenas). In Chicago the big crowds sell through festival sites, so AXS adds little there.

Coverage counts below come from what searches surfaced, not a full audit of each seller.

1. LA sample, Aug 1 – Oct 31, 2026

25 events (37 show dates) found with a likely crowd of 5,000+ and no Ticketmaster sale. "LA area" here includes Orange County and the Inland Empire; capacities are as stated or reported, and blanks mean none was found.

Event	Date	Venue	Primary seller	Promoter	Capacity (source)
HARD Summer	Aug 1–2	Hollywood Park, Inglewood	Front Gate (2025 edition, EDM Identity)	HARD / Insomniac	~85,000/day, sold out in 2025 (EDM Identity)

Event	Date	Venue	Primary seller	Promoter	Capacity (source)
Megan Moroney	Aug 7–8	Crypto.com Arena	AXS (AXS)	Not stated	20,000+ seats (AXS)
Head in the Clouds	Aug 8–9	Rose Bowl / Brookside	Unverified	88rising (unverified)	Unverified (listing)
KCON LA (3 nights)	Aug 14–16	Crypto.com Arena	AXS (AXS)	CJ ENM (unverified)	20,000+ seats (AXS)
Just Like Heaven	Aug 22	Brookside at the Rose Bowl	Festival site (platform unverified)	Goldenvoice	Unverified
Rossi	Aug 22	Exposition Lawn, Exposition Park	DICE (Framework's channel)	Framework	Same park drew 12,000 sold out for Disco Lines, May 2 (EDMTunes)
MAMAMOO	Aug 25	Crypto.com Arena	AXS	Not stated	20,000+ seats (AXS)
J. Cole	Sep 1	Crypto.com Arena	AXS	Not stated	20,000+ seats (AXS)
Hollywood Bowl LA Phil shows: Buddy Guy (Sep 9), OneRepublic Fireworks Finale (Sep 11–12), Jazz at Lincoln Center (Sep 23)	Sep 9–23	Hollywood Bowl	hollywoodbowl.com (NBC LA)	LA Phil	17,500 seats (KTLA)
Sun Soaked	Sep 12	Huntington State Beach	sunsoaked.insomniac.com	Kaskade + Insomniac	Unverified; 2025 sold out
Ben Sterling (Planet X)	Sep 12	California Plaza, DTLA	DICE (Framework's channel)	Framework	Unverified
Nocturnal Wonderland	Sep 19–20	Glen Helen Regional Park, San Bernardino	Front Gate (EDM Identity)	Insomniac	80,000+ over the 2023 weekend, per sheriff (Fontana Herald News)

Event	Date	Venue	Primary seller	Promoter	Capacity (source)
Francis Mercier + Shimza	Sep 19	Reframe Studios Outdoors, Atwater Village	DICE (Framework's channel)	Framework	Lot held a 9,000-person show (Bisnow)
Ocean Way	Sep 26–27	Santa Monica Beach	oceanwayfestival.com (platform unverified)	Goldenvoice	Up to 35,000/day (Locale)
Disney Worlds Collide; Jungle; Kacey Musgraves (2); Weezer; YG	Sep 28; Oct 10; Oct 18–19; Oct 24; Oct 28	Crypto.com Arena	AXS (AXS, AXS)	Not stated	20,000+ seats (AXS)
Prospa (3 shows)	Oct 14–16	Shrine Expo Hall	AXS (Framework)	Framework + Goldenvoice	5,000 standing, borderline (AEG)
PAWSA	Oct 17	Rio Vista Lot, Historic Sears Building	DICE; listed on AXS	Framework + Goldenvoice	Unverified; waitlist on Framework
Hugel	Oct 24	Reframe Studios Outdoors	DICE (Framework)	Framework + Goldenvoice	Same lot as above, 9,000 precedent
Escape Halloween	Oct 30–31	NOS Events Center, San Bernardino	Front Gate (EDM Identity)	Insomniac	125,000 over two nights in 2017 (Fontana Herald News)

PAWSA's address conflicts: DICE says 1485 Rio Vista Ave, Framework says 1951. Possible extra candidates I could not size: The Soulection Experience (Oct 3, Reframe Studios Outdoors) and Day Trip in the Park (Aug 16 and 23, LA State Historic Park). Hollywood Bowl shows booked by Live Nation sell on Ticketmaster and are excluded.

2. Sources: coverage and machine access

AXS carried the most sample dates I could confirm; SeatGeek is the only seller with an official, self-serve events API. "Seen" counts are listings that surfaced in searches, so treat them as lower bounds.

Source	Sample events seen	Machine access	Terms / limits
AXS	17 dates: 13 Crypto.com Arena dates, 3 Prospa, and the PAWSA listing that hands off to DICE (AXS PAWSA)	Public HTML venue and event pages; no public API found (unverified)	Terms of use not reviewed in detail
DICE	5 Framework shows (Rossi, Ben Sterling, Francis Mercier, PAWSA, Hugel)	Partner-only GraphQL API (API profile); public pages embed structured event data with organizer (DICE)	API requires being a DICE selling partner; scraping terms unverified
Front Gate Tickets	3 Insomniac festivals (HARD, Nocturnal, Escape); Sun Soaked likely	No public API found (unverified)	Unverified
SeatGeek	Hugel (SeatGeek); others not checked	Official REST API, `/2/events`, free client ID (guide)	API terms apply; review before commercial use
StubHub	PAWSA (StubHub)	Structured page data (JSON-LD seen); no public API (unverified)	Unverified
Vivid Seats	Escape, Sun Soaked, Rio Vista Lot venue page (Vivid)	Affiliate access only (unverified)	Unverified
TickPick	Hugel, Soulection, Day Trip (TickPick)	None found	Unverified
Eventbrite	0	Public search API shut off Feb 2020; only by event, venue or organizer ID (GitHub notice)	Organization endpoints need a known ID

Source	Sample events seen	Machine access	Terms / limits
Resident Advisor	Nocturnal Wonderland; Rio Vista Lot venue page (RA)	No official API; site's internal GraphQL is used by third parties (PyPI)	Terms reserve all rights; get permission first
Framework site	All Framework LA shows	The Events Calendar REST API (page metadata shows `tec-api` v1, site)	Unverified
Insomniac / Goldenvoice sites	Their own events	Public pages; press sites list dates (Insomniac press)	Unverified
hollywoodbowl.com	LA Phil Bowl shows	Public pages only	Unverified
JamBase (aggregator)	Crypto.com Arena shows seen; others not checked (JamBase)	Paid REST API, free developer tier; says it pulls 60+ sources incl. AXS, DICE, Eventbrite (JamBase)	Licensed data, plan rate limits

Live Nation outside Ticketmaster mostly means Front Gate here (Insomniac and C3 festivals); I did not find a separate Live Nation feed.

3. Recommendation

Start with the SeatGeek API plus an AXS crawl: SeatGeek is the one official, free events API, and AXS holds the arena shows and the Goldenvoice co-promoted DICE pop-ups.

1. **SeatGeek API (catch-all).** Query by city and date window each night. Resale listings appear for pop-ups (Hugel was there) and for sold-out shows, which are exactly the big ones.
2. **AXS venue and artist pages.** Crawl the LA venue pages (Crypto.com Arena, Shrine, Greek, Peacock) and Goldenvoice listings. Check the AXS terms of use first, since there is no public API.

3. **Trial JamBase before building more scrapers.** If its claimed AXS, DICE and Front Gate coverage holds for this sample, it replaces steps 2 and 4.
4. **Small promoter watch list** for the highest-impact pop-ups: Framework (REST API), Insomniac and Goldenvoice. These also give the best capacity statements.

Resale as catch-all: partial. It catches sold-out and high-demand shows across sellers, but misses free events, non-transferable tickets (the Bowl's $1 seats cannot be resold, per NBC LA), and shows that sell slowly. Resale pages also sometimes use vague venue names, so match on date and coordinates, not venue strings.

Next step: run SeatGeek and JamBase against the 25-event table above and count hits before choosing.

4. Pop-up sizing

Permits and city contracts give the most trustworthy numbers, but for LA pop-ups the number you can actually get is usually a promoter press release; use it, discounted, and flag the source.

Where a capacity can be found

Source	Example	Reliability
City contract or permit cap	Lollapalooza's 115,000 daily cap is set in its city contract (Chicago Tribune via Recorder); Riot Fest's park contract estimates 150,000 tickets over three days (WBEZ)	High: a legal ceiling
LA City permits	LAFD's Public Assemblage Unit issues event permits and sets occupancy limits (LAFD); LADBS temporary event permits need an LAFD-approved safety plan (LADBS)	High, but whether these are publicly searchable is unverified; may need a records request
Police or sheriff counts	80,000+ at Nocturnal Wonderland 2023 (Fontana Herald News)	Medium-high; after the fact
Promoter statements	9,000 at Reframe (Bisnow); 12,000 at Exposition Park (EDMTunes)	Medium; rounded and self-interested

Source	Example	Reliability
Venue rental specs	Shrine Expo Hall 5,000 standing (AEG)	Medium-high for fixed sites
Aggregator capacity fields	FestivalMates lists Escape at 20,000 (FestivalMates), far under its reported crowds; Songkick lists LA State Historic Park at 2,000 (Songkick) despite sold-out multi-day shows there	Low; do not use

How often big pop-ups sell out

Most large pop-ups with published results were reported sold out, but promoters publicize sell-outs and stay quiet otherwise, so this overstates the rate.

Event	Reported crowd	Source
Disco Lines, Exposition Park (May 2026)	12,000, sold out	EDMTunes
&ME, Cabrillo Beach (May 2026)	6,000+, sold out	EDMTunes
Chris Lake, LA State Historic Park (June 2026, 2 days)	Sold out, size not stated	EDMTunes
re:frame season 1 (8 shows)	30,000+ total, all sold out	EDM.com
HARD Summer 2025	~85,000/day, sold out	EDM Identity
Sun Soaked 2025	Sold out, size not stated	EDM.com
Fisher + Chris Lake, Hollywood Blvd	12,000	Pollstar

Proposed sizing rule

The percentages below are my proposal, not sourced; calibrate them against permit or police counts as you collect them.

1. **Start from the best capacity available**, in the reliability order above. For multi-day events, use the per-day figure.

2. **Default expected crowd = 80% of stated capacity.**
3. **Raise to 95%** if the seller shows sold out or a waitlist (PAWSA's waitlist on Framework's site is this signal), or if resale prices sit above face value.
4. **No capacity found:** use the same venue's or brand's best past result (Reframe lot: 9,000).
5. **No history either:** estimate from usable area. Clark County's outdoor-assembly guide uses 7 sq ft per person (Clark County); mark the result "estimated".
6. **Still nothing:** keep the event on the map as "unsized, likely 5,000+" if it is a lot, park or beach show from a promoter with a 5,000+ track record; drop it otherwise.

5. Chicago and Las Vegas spot check

The AXS half of the recommendation holds in Las Vegas but not Chicago, where the biggest crowds sell through festival websites; SeatGeek and JamBase still need testing in both.

Chicago

Event	Date	Venue	Seller	Promoter	Capacity (source)
Lollapalooza (in-window days)	Aug 1–2 (runs Jul 30–Aug 2)	Grant Park	lollapalooza.com	C3 Presents (Live Nation)	115,000/day cap (Chicago Tribune via Recorder)
ARC Music Festival	Sep 4–7	Union Park	arcmusicfestival.com (EDMTunes)	Auris Presents	Unverified
Riot Fest	Sep 18–20	Douglass Park	riotfest.org; one comparison site lists Ticketmaster (Stereoboard), so verify	Riot Fest	Up to 50,000/day (WBEZ)

Las Vegas

Event	Date	Venue	Seller	Promoter	Capacity (source)
iHeartRadio Music Festival	Sep 18–19	T-Mobile Arena	AXS (iHeartMedia)	iHeartMedia	12,000–20,000 for concerts (T-Mobile Arena)
Weezer	Oct 23	T-Mobile Arena	AXS (AXS)	Not stated	Same

Event	Date	Venue	Seller	Promoter	Capacity (source)
Doja Cat	Oct 31	T-Mobile Arena	AXS (AXS)	Not stated	Same

- MGM Grand Garden Arena (17,000) and Michelob ULTRA Arena (12,000) also sell on AXS (AXS); I did not list their shows.
- When We Were Young is skipping 2026 (News 3 LV), yet a festival aggregator still lists it (Frontstage), a reminder to drop events not confirmed by a primary seller.
- Life is Beautiful 2026 dates and status are unverified.
- No large DICE pop-ups turned up in either city in my searches.

Caveats and unverified items

- **Not a full census.** The LA table is what searches surfaced; Peacock Theater, Shrine Auditorium, Greek Theatre (split between AXS and Ticketmaster) and Intuit Dome shows were not checked show by show.
- **Seller platforms marked "festival site"** (Ocean Way, Just Like Heaven, ARC, Lollapalooza) were not traced to the underlying ticketing company.
- **No capacity found** for PAWSA's Rio Vista Lot, California Plaza, Sun Soaked, Just Like Heaven, Head in the Clouds or ARC.
- **API access and terms** for AXS, Front Gate, StubHub and Vivid Seats were not confirmed; read each terms page before automated collection.
- **Free shows** are invisible to every seller here; none were sized in this pass.
- **The sizing percentages** (80% / 95%) are a proposal to calibrate, not a measured rate.